



Advanced Linear Algebra: Foundations to Frontiers

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3.2.6 Cost of Gram-Schmidt algorithms ¶

(No video for this unit.)

Homework 3.2.6.1. Analyze the cost of the CGS algorithm in [Figure 3.2.4.2](#) (left) assuming that $A \in \mathbb{C}^{m \times n}$.

▼ [Solution](#)

During the k th iteration ($0 \leq k < n$), A_0 has k columns and A_2 has $n - k - 1$ columns. In each iteration

Operation	Approximate cost (in flops)
$r_{01} := A_0^H a_1$	$2mk$
$a_1 := a_1 - A_0 r_{01}$	$2mk$
$\rho_{11} := \ a_1\ _2$	$2m$
$a_1 := a_1 / \rho_{11}$	m

Thus, the total cost is (approximately)

$$\begin{aligned}
 & \sum_{k=0}^{n-1} [2mk + 2mk + 2m + m] \\
 &= \\
 & \sum_{k=0}^{n-1} [3m + 4mk] \\
 &= \\
 & 3mn + 4m \sum_{k=0}^{n-1} k \\
 & \approx < \sum_{k=0}^{n-1} k = n(n-1)/2 \approx n^2/2 > \\
 & 3mn + 4m \frac{n^2}{2} \\
 &= \\
 & 3mn + 2mn^2 \\
 & \approx < 3mn \text{ is of lower order} > \\
 & 2mn^2
 \end{aligned}$$

Homework 3.2.6.2. Analyze the cost of the MGS algorithm in [Figure 3.2.4.2](#) (right) assuming that $A \in \mathbb{C}^{m \times n}$.

▼ [Solution](#)

During the k th iteration ($0 \leq k < n$), A_0 has k columns. and A_2 has $n - k - 1$ columns. In each iteration

Operation	Approximate cost (in flops)
$\rho_{11} := \ a_1\ _2$	$2m$
$a_1 := a_1 / \rho_{11}$	m
$r_{12}^T := a_1^H A_2$	$2m(n - k - 1)$
$A_2 := A_2 - a_1 r_{12}^T$	$2m(n - k - 1)$

Thus, the total cost is (approximately)

$$\begin{aligned}
 & \sum_{k=0}^{n-1} [2m(n - k - 1) + 2m(n - k - 1) + 2m + m] \\
 &= \\
 & \sum_{k=0}^{n-1} [3m + 4m(n - k - 1)] \\
 &= \\
 & 3mn + 4m \sum_{k=0}^{n-1} (n - k - 1) \\
 &= \quad < \text{Substitute } j = (n - k - 1) > \\
 & 3mn + 4m \sum_{j=0}^{n-1} j \\
 & \approx \quad < \sum_{j=0}^{n-1} j = n(n - 1)/2 \approx n^2/2 > \\
 & 3mn + 4m \frac{n^2}{2} \\
 &= \\
 & 3mn + 2mn^2 \\
 & \approx \quad < 3mn \text{ is of lower order} > \\
 & 2mn^2
 \end{aligned}$$

Homework 3.2.6.3. Which algorithm requires more flops?

▼ **Solution**

They require the approximately same number of flops.

A more careful analysis shows that, in exact arithmetic, they perform exactly the same computations, but in a different order. Hence the number of flops is exactly the same.